



London Committee

Sadiq Khan (Mayor of London)
New London Plan
GLA City Hall
London Plan Team
Post Point 18
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London SE1 2AA

28 February 2018

Dear Mr Khan,

Draft New London Plan

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on this vision document for London. We are responding on behalf of the London Committee of the Association of Local Government Archaeological Officers: England.

The Association of Local Government Archaeological Officers (ALGAO) is the national body representing local government archaeology services at County, District, Metropolitan, Unitary and National Park authority level. These provide advice to nearly all the District, Unitary and other local government bodies in the country.

ALGAO: England co-ordinates the views of its member authorities (92 in total) and presents them to government and to other national organisations. It also acts as an advisor to the Local Government Association (LGA) on archaeological matters. The range of interests of our members embraces all aspects of the historic environment, including archaeology, buildings and the historic landscape, and our stated aims are to:

- Provide a strong voice for local authority historic environment services and promote these to strengthen and develop their role within local government in delivering local and national government policy
- Ensure local government historic environment services are included within policy (national and local) for culture and education
- Ensure that policy aims to improve the sustainable management of the historic environment

- Promote the development of high standards in the historic environment profession

Greater London is unlike the rest of England because Historic England provides the capital's Historic Environment Record, and also archaeological advice to the GLA and borough councils other than the City of London and Southwark who employ their own archaeologists. ALGAO's London committee covers the whole of Greater London including the City and Southwark.

General comments

People have lived in the London area for half a million years or more and the city has almost two thousand years of urban history ago during which time it has been England's leading urban centre. The dynamism, diversity and internationalism of modern London has deep roots which are reflected in and supported by its physical fabric. As a consequence, London has one of the greatest urban time-depths of the world's leading modern cities; its internationally significant archaeological resource reflects that legacy and is a cause for pride. We recognise that the city both faces major challenges across a wide range of policy areas and in that context welcome the document's positive engagement and policy on London's heritage, including archaeology.

The National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) makes it a core principle that heritage assets should be conserved in a manner appropriate to their significance and that conservation and enhancement of the historic environment is a Local Plan strategic priority which should be supported by a clear strategy. Managing London's archaeology for public benefit needs a workable planning policy and implementation framework because most archaeological interest is not covered designated heritage assets.

Archaeology in London can provide dramatic new discoveries which on occasion reach an international audience building the city's 'brand', such as the Elizabethan Theatres of Southwark and Shoreditch. But this is only part of the story, because there is so much development needed we also need policies which allow us to combine the old with the new through innovative design, place-shaping and a role in community, culture and even the creative industries. The newly restored London Mithraeum provides an outstanding example.

We emphasise that however that archaeology is not simply about the discovery of buried remains and their excavation but about historic sites and landscapes which form part of our living environment. Examples range from the ruins of London's Roman and medieval walls to the historic garden earthworks of Wanstead Park to our industrial heritage of canals and artificial waterways, and historic rural landscapes such as Epping Forest and Wimbledon Common.

ALGAO: London responded positively to the Mayor's 2016 consultation on 'A City for All Londoners' emphasising the significance and public value of the capital's archaeology. This was followed up with an Archaeology Topic Paper endorsed

by other leading organisations in the archaeological sector, which provided supporting evidence, case studies and policy advice: <https://content.historicengland.org.uk/content/docs/get-involved/london-plan-archaeology-topic-paper-delivering-public-benefits.pdf>

That paper recommended that the public value of archaeology to local residents, visitors and tourists should be recognized in the new London Plan and its supporting strategies, specifically:

1. Maintain existing policy for managing heritage assets of archaeological interest, including securing public benefits.
2. Properly recognise the role of the Greater London Historic Environment Record as a key information source and the desirability of making it more accessible, comprehensive in its coverage and better used.
3. Include explicit reference to identifying archaeological potential using Archaeological Priority Areas or equivalent approaches in plan-making and decision-taking, including recognizing that some non-designated heritage assets are of national importance.
4. Provide appropriate safeguards in relation to the allocation of sites for 'permission in principle' where there is a significant risk to archaeological interest.
5. Better recognise the archaeological and historical interest relevant in policies for open spaces, geology, trees and woodlands and water bodies.
6. Recognise that archaeological investigations should be undertaken by suitably qualified individuals or organisations in order to advance understanding and better reveal significance. Explain that this includes analysis, publication and archiving of results to inform future work and that in some cases better results can be obtained by a common brief or working arrangement across several sites.
7. Support a consistent London-wide approach to strategic characterisation drawing upon established best practice by enhancing the Greater London Historic Environment Record.
8. Recognise the importance of maintaining and enhancing the Museum of London Archaeological Archive as part of the city's critical cultural infrastructure necessary for sustainable development.

We are pleased to see that points 1 to 3 and 6 have been addressed in the draft plan. However, we are still concerned about the threat to undesignated archaeology from ill-considered Permission in Principle (point 4) on 'small sites' and object to policy H2 as currently worded.

We have also suggested below some amendments to improve linkages to other policy areas (point 5) and have separately commented on the weakness of the Environment Strategy's approach to green infrastructure in this respect.

We would welcome a clearer commitment to a consistent London-wide approach to historic characterisation (point 7).

We suggest that the Museum of London Archaeological Archive (point 8) should feature in the forthcoming Culture Strategy. We look forward to this strategy with interest to see how it encompassed the historic environment, and archaeology in particular. We note that there are many local heritage interest groups and much of public value in London's historic environment that can be captured in planning policy and as an integral part of a Cultural or Heritage Strategy.

Specific comments related the new London Plan:

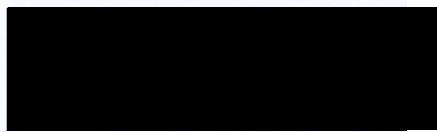
Policy/ Paragraph	Comment
1.2.6	Welcome reference to 'National Park City' but note that the cultural heritage dimension of National Parks is not evident in the London definition at present. For the ambition to be meaningful it needs to be carried forward in relevant chapters later in the plan and encompass cultural heritage in an analogous way to National Parks.
Chapter 2	Spatial Development Pattern
SD1	Omission: There is no mention of the historic environment in the considerations for bringing forward and delivering Opportunity Areas. OA Planning Frameworks should scope archaeology alongside other heritage and environmental issues and include specific delivery strategies where appropriate. Please see Historic England's comments on Housing Strategy for suggestions on how this approach might work.
SD4	Support reference in part C to sustaining and enhancing heritage of the CAZ. The CAZ encompasses the historic core of the medieval and Roman city so archaeological remains contribute to that distinctiveness and so protecting them should be mentioned in 2.4.7.
Chapter 3	Design
D1	Support part B4 for design to respect heritage assets – this should include archaeological assets
D2	Support part A7 for 'evaluation' for Development Plans to cover historical evolution and heritage assets – again this should include archaeological assets and would normally involve a review and if necessary update of a borough's Archaeological Priority Areas.
D7	Welcome reference in part A to public realm relating to historic context
D9	Welcome reference in supporting text to harm to archaeology in relation to basement development

Chapter 4	Housing
GG4 H1 Part C H2	<u>Object to Policy H2.</u> We are concern about the threat to undesignated archaeology from ill-considered Permission in Principle on 'small sites'. Neither SMAA nor SHLAA considered archaeology despite our representations so further sifting would be necessary to identify sites where granting of permission in principle could cause significant or substantial harm, and potentially without adequate framework for mitigation. Informed use of up to date Archaeological Priority Areas could help manage this risk. We request a change to H2 part F to say that the presumption should not apply if the development would be likely to cause significant harm to heritage assets of archaeological interest.
Chapter 5	Social Infrastructure
S7	Request a statement that historic burial grounds are heritage assets, often undesignated. It is unclear if the policy applies only to cemeteries still in use. National guidance published by Historic England and the Church of England establishes that burials over 100 years old are likely to be of archaeological interest which should be considered in relation to proposed clearance or re-use with preference for protection.
Chapter 7	Heritage and Culture
HC1	Support this policy as worded and regard it as vital to the delivery of sustainable development in London. We welcome recognition of the London Archaeological Priority Area Review Programme and the Greater London Historic Environment Record. Figure 7.5 will need to be updated in the final version of the plan to include all boroughs where reviews will have been completed by then – adding in at least Camden, Hackney, Islington, Southwark and Wandsworth.
Chapter 8	Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment
G1 G2 G3	Welcome reference to historic interest under G3 for Metropolitan Open Land but we note this also applies to Greenbelt and Green Infrastructure and should be referenced there too. We consider that Historic Landscape Characterisation (promoted outside London by Historic England and referred to in NPPF paragraph 171) could be applied to better understand the contribution of the historic environment to green spaces and blue/green infrastructure.
G7	Request recognition of ancient woodlands as heritage assets and a 'reserve' of preserved archaeological interest.
G10	There is an overlap between archaeology and geo-diversity but a lack of policy relating to such investigation. We suggest the addition of a sentence to the supporting text: "Prehistoric archaeological remains and associated flora and fauna can be found within geological deposits of the Quaternary Period which can therefore hold archaeological interest".
Chapter 9	Sustainable Infrastructure
SI10	Request addition to Part D to say that Development Plans should require adequate evaluation and mitigation of archaeological impact because minerals extraction can be immensely destructive of archaeological remains over large areas. Gravel deposits were particularly attractive for early agricultural communities as a result

	of which such deposits are known to be rich in archaeology along the entire length of the Thames Valley, most notably in London the plateau around Heathrow and in North East London.
SI17	Welcome recognition of the heritage value of waterways. Canals, docks and the like are an important part of London's industrial heritage.
Monitoring	Welcome an indicator for heritage but we are concerned that the focus of monitoring on designated assets is biased against archaeology due to the highly selective approach to scheduling in comparison with listed buildings which will dominate any statistics. We suggest that the methodology should also consider including substantial harm or loss of undesignated heritage assets of archaeological interest equivalent to scheduled monuments thus giving them the same status as designated assets accorded to them by the NPPF.

We would be happy to discuss any of the points raised above and/or suggest specific changes to address the concerns. Should any key aspects of the archaeological policies be subject to challenge we would be willing to provide expert evidence in support of them.

Yours sincerely,



Mr Sandy Kidd MA MCIfA MRTPI FSA

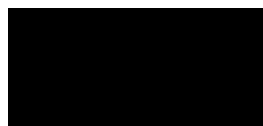
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